GITHUB · API KEY

API KEY ON *GITHUB?*



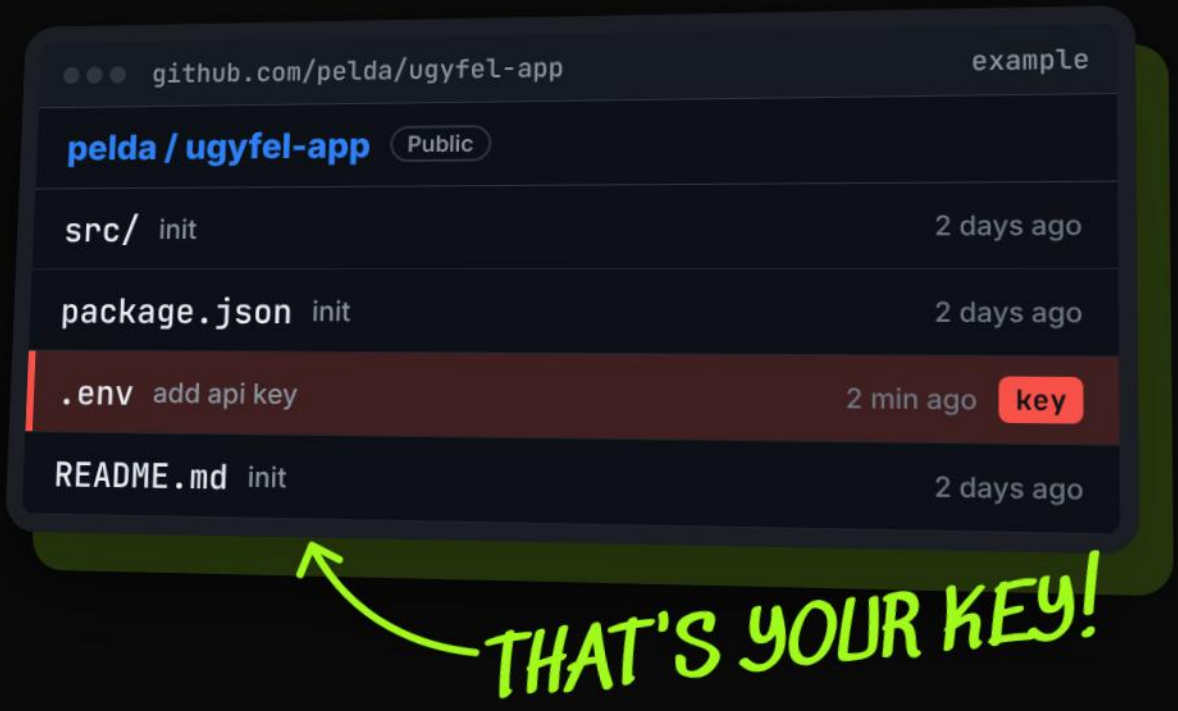
Swipe →

THE RISK

02

ANYONE CAN *SEE IT.*

In a public repo, anyone can open your .env file and copy the key out of it.



PUSH PROTECTION

03

ONLY *PARTLY* SAFE.

GitHub blocks the push by default when it spots a known key. But it can be let through, and it doesn't recognize every key.

GitHub Blog · Feb 29, 2024

terminal · git push — example

```
$ git push origin main
remote: error: GH013: Repository rule
remote: violations found
remote: — Push cannot contain secrets —
remote: OpenAI API Key · path: .env
remote: To push, follow this URL to
remote: allow the secret: …/unblock-secret/…
```

CAN BE SKIPPED!

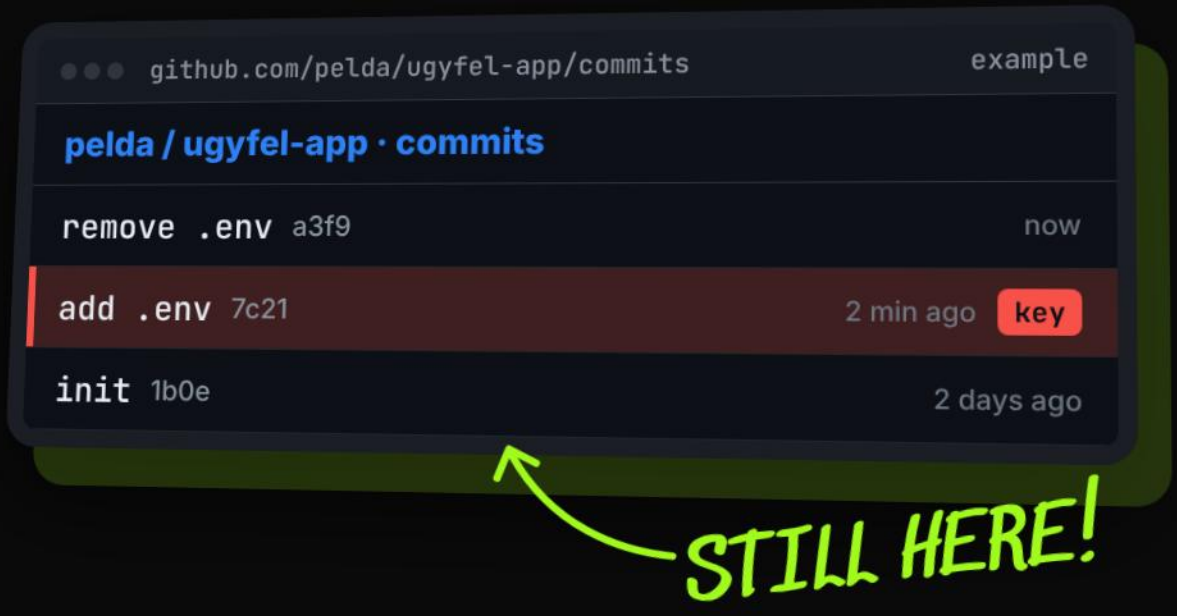
COMMIT HISTORY

04

DELETED IT?
STILL THERE.

A new commit doesn't erase the old one: the key stays in earlier commits, forks and clones.

GitHub Docs · Removing sensitive data



WHAT TO DO

05

STEP ONE: *NEW KEY.*

According to GitHub, the first step is to revoke and replace the key.

GitHub Docs · Removing sensitive data

1. Revoke the old key
2. Get a new one from the provider
3. .env → .gitignore
4. New key in your host's env variables

THIS FIRST!

BUILT YOUR APP WITH AI?

WANT ME TO *TAKE A LOOK?*

I'll check where a key or password might be exposed.



Message me →